

Board: 2

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6 ♠

Declarer: North

Board: 4

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4 ♥

Declarer: East

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 3
♥ K Q 8 5
♦ 9 7 5 4
♣ Q 8 4

♠ A Q J 2

♥ J 10 3

♦ A K 10

♣ J 10 3



♠ 7 5

♥ 9 7 4 2

♦ 8 6 2

♣ 7 6 5 2

♠ K 9 8 6 4

♥ A 6

♦ Q J 3

♣ A K 9

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♥
Pass	2♠	Pass	5NT
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			

6♠ by North

has sent you a clear signal that he holds an EVEN number of ♥s. In this case an even number must be 4 which means that North has one more ♥. So you play your ♥K. He ruffs in dummy of course, but then has no way to get rid of that ♣ loser when the finesse fails.

[showcards W:S5]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. The 2♥ bid was a transfer. The 5NT bid meant to choose either 6♠ or 6NT. North liked the suit. Partner led the ♠5, won by North's ♠Q. North pulls one more trump with his ♠A, then wins three high ♦s. Next comes dummy's ♥A on which he plays the ♥3 and East plays the ♥9. Then he leads dummy's ♥6 which you win with the ♥Q. On this trick North drops the ♥J and East the ♥2. It is your play.

Play the ♥K.

If you believe North is now out of ♥s then you should not play your ♥K because it would give him a ruff-sluff.

But you shouldn't believe North when your partner has sent you a clear signal that he holds an EVEN number of ♥s. In this case an even number must be 4 which means that North has one more ♥. So you play your ♥K. He ruffs in dummy of course, but then has no way to get rid of that ♣ loser when the finesse fails.

If you had not been paying attention to East's signal you might have decided to risk a ♣ lead - with a disastrous result.

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ 6 4
 ♥ A J 8
 ♦ A Q J 6
 ♣ 8 7 5 4

♠ 9 8 7 5 2

♥ 10 5

♦ 9 7 4 3

♣ Q 2



♠ K J 3
 ♥ K Q 7 6 4 3
 ♦ K 10
 ♣ J 9

♠ A Q 10

♥ 9 2

♦ 8 5 2

♣ A K 10 6 3

West	North	East	South
			1 ♣
Pass	Pass	1 ♥	Pass
2 ♣	Pass	4 ♥	
All Pass			
4 ♥ by East			

[showcards W:CA E:C2 S:C9 N:C4]

You are South. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♣A, North played the ♣2 and East the ♣9. What should you play to the second trick?

Play the ♣6.

On first thought North's ♣2 seems to be a discouraging signal. Think again.

After the first trick you know the location of every ♣ except the ♣Q and ♣J. If North started with ♣ J 2 he would have signaled with the ♣J. If North started with ♣ Q J 2 he would have signaled with the ♣Q. Since he did neither he started either with singleton ♣ 2 or with ♣ Q 2. In either case you should play a low ♣ now which he will either win with his ♣Q or he will ruff.

It turns out that he wins with the ♣Q, then leads a ♠ back to your ♠ A Q.